



IIT Madras
B.S. Degree

STRATEGIES FOR PROFESSIONAL GROWTH

Week 1

Teamwork and Getting Along



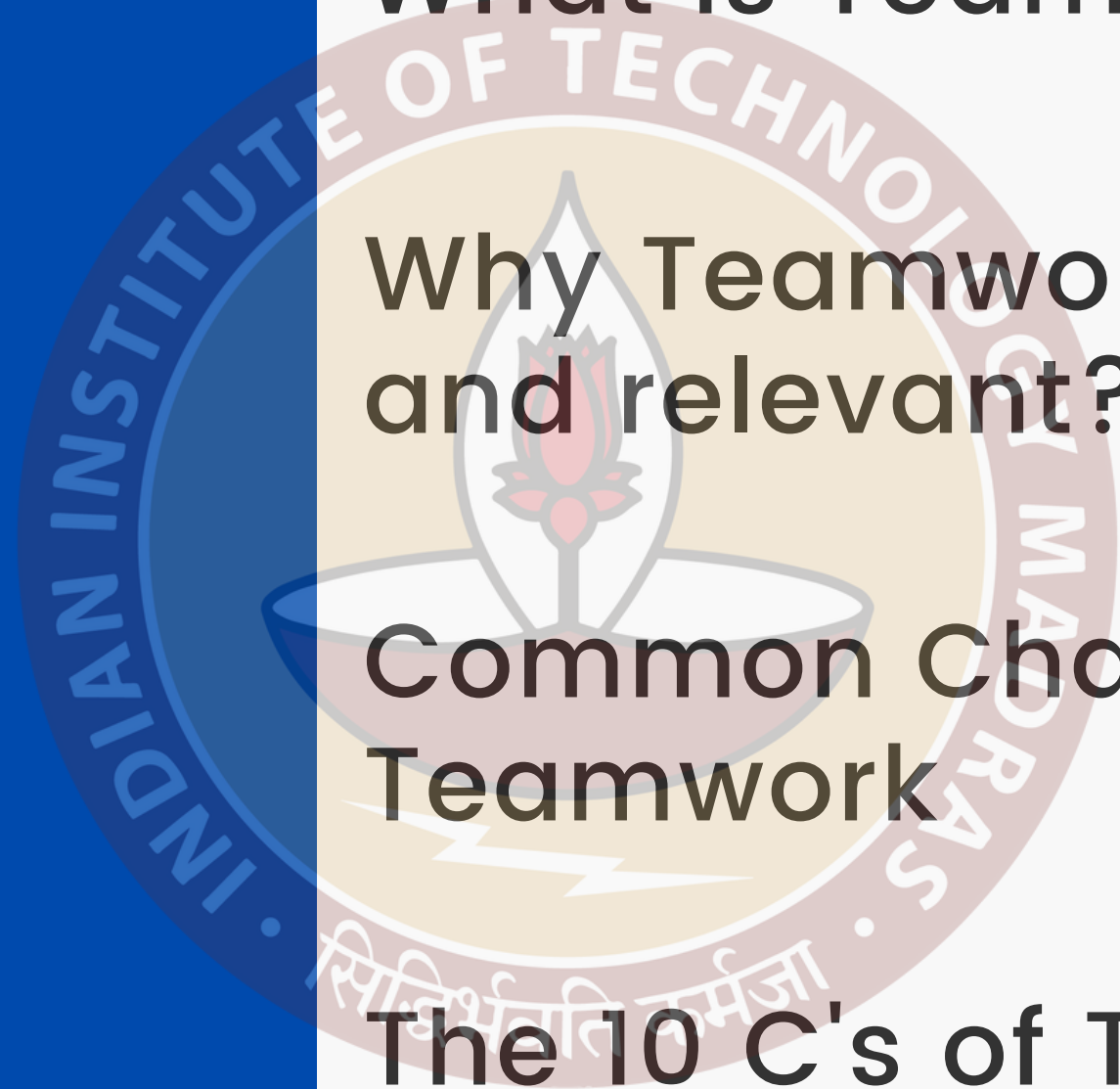
Teamwork and Getting Along

What is Teamwork?

Why Teamwork is important
and relevant?

Common Challenges in
Teamwork

The 10 C's of Teamwork



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TEAMWORK

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Why Teamwork is important and relevant?



- Builds competitive advantage
- Saves time, energy, costs and resources
- Covers competency and skill gaps
- Improves workforce efficiency and productivity
- Inspires ideation, creativity & innovation
- Builds higher morale
- Peer learning and self-improvement
- Creates synergy
- Enhances workplace experience
- Balances needs & goals of organization

TEAMWORK

Common Challenges in Teamwork

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- Lack of Honesty and Trust
- Conflict and Tension
- Comparison and Competition
- Lack of Transparency
- No long term thinking
- Working in silos
- Lack of direction
- Lack of common goals
- Not managing the Weakest Link



STRATEGIES FOR PROFESSIONAL GROWTH

Week 1 - Teamwork and Getting Along

What are some of the challenges associated with working in a team?
Illustrate with an example.



Post your answer in the Discussion Forum

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Collaboration
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Conflict Resolution
Change Management
Continuous
Improvement

The 10 C's of Teamwork

1. Clarity
2. Commitment
3. Communication
4. Competence
5. Collaboration
6. Coordination
7. Connection
8. Conflict Resolution
9. Change Management
10. Continuous Improvement



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I. CLARITY



Align and balance organization, team and individual:

- Vision
- Purpose
- Mission
- Core Values

Clear and well-defined:

- Roles & responsibilities with accountability
- Individual and shared goals & objectives
- Rules, policies, standards, processes

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II. COMMITMENT

- Clearly defined roles and responsibilities, shared vision and SLAs (Service Level Agreements)
- Convert expectations & intentions into clear (written) agreements which results in clear outcomes, timelines, deliverables
- Commitment is an Honor Code, it is to yourself – it is “Personal and Internal”
- Commitment makes you go the extra mile to put in your best
- Value team members and their contribution to inspire commitment



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III. COMMUNICATION

- Create space to ask questions, and give answers
- Share ideas, experiences, and best practices
- Empower through open, honest, transparent interaction
- Clear guidelines for email, messages, meetings, Minutes of Meeting (MOM), internal and external communication
- Streamlined process for feedback, escalation, appraisals, follow-ups and timelines



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IV. COMPETENCE

- Core competence is getting along, working together in harmony towards a shared goal and shared vision
- Diverse competencies to bridge gaps
- Complementary strengths, talents, abilities and skills
- Lead oneself by taking responsibility, initiative and ownership
- Contribute like a team member (not as an individual)



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IV. COMPETENCE

Team members of a NASCAR race car driver's pit crew shown here work toward the common goal of winning the race. Providing direction, momentum, and commitment, the pit crew's plan is to function at top speed with no errors in checking the car, fixing parts, changing tires, and pumping gas. Each member of the pit crew has a specific job and a clear sense of what needs to be done. And each member continuously fine-tunes his job to shave time off the pit stops, which are so important because they may win or lose a race.



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V. COLLABORATION

- Generation of ideas by activating a team's collective talents and skills
- Provide equal access to opportunities and resources
- Exchange of creative and innovative ideas (irrespective and independent of authority and hierarchy)
- Facilitate shared leadership towards common goals
- Use collaborative tools and streamlined processes for shared tasks across locations and teams



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VI. COORDINATION

- Coordination is all about convergent thinking
- Converge on one or two ideas and then plan, schedule, execute
- Integrate execution plans
- Visibility on each other's progress and direction
- Assist and support peers



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VII. CONNECTION

- Formal team building to build self-worth, self-trust, and mutual trust
- Informal get-togethers
- Cultivate empathy and caring through good and bad times
- Offer guidance and support to one another
- Acknowledge and appreciate milestones and successes



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VIII. CONFLICT RESOLUTION

- Clear rules and guidelines for different types and severities of conflict
- Well-defined escalation and resolution mechanism
- Effective communication and listening
- Build preventive and proactive strategies

It takes both sides
to build a bridge.

~ Fredrik Nael



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IX. CHANGE MANAGEMENT

Change management means to plan, initiate, control and then finally stabilize the change processes on both organizational and personnel levels.

Two perspectives:

1. Organizational change management (top-level/ managerial/ for overall organization)
2. Individual change management (lower-level/ employee transition)

- Training and development to empower team members
- Set goals and objectives so that it is clear how everyone's role contributes to the bigger picture.
- Engage team members and manage resistance to change



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X. CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT

- Course correction with comprehensive feedback loops
- Learn, improvise, iterate and grow
- Adaptive to change
- Workshops and team trainings to upgrade competencies and skills
- Lean and iterative processes
- Tiny steps and tiny gains
- Surveys and assessments



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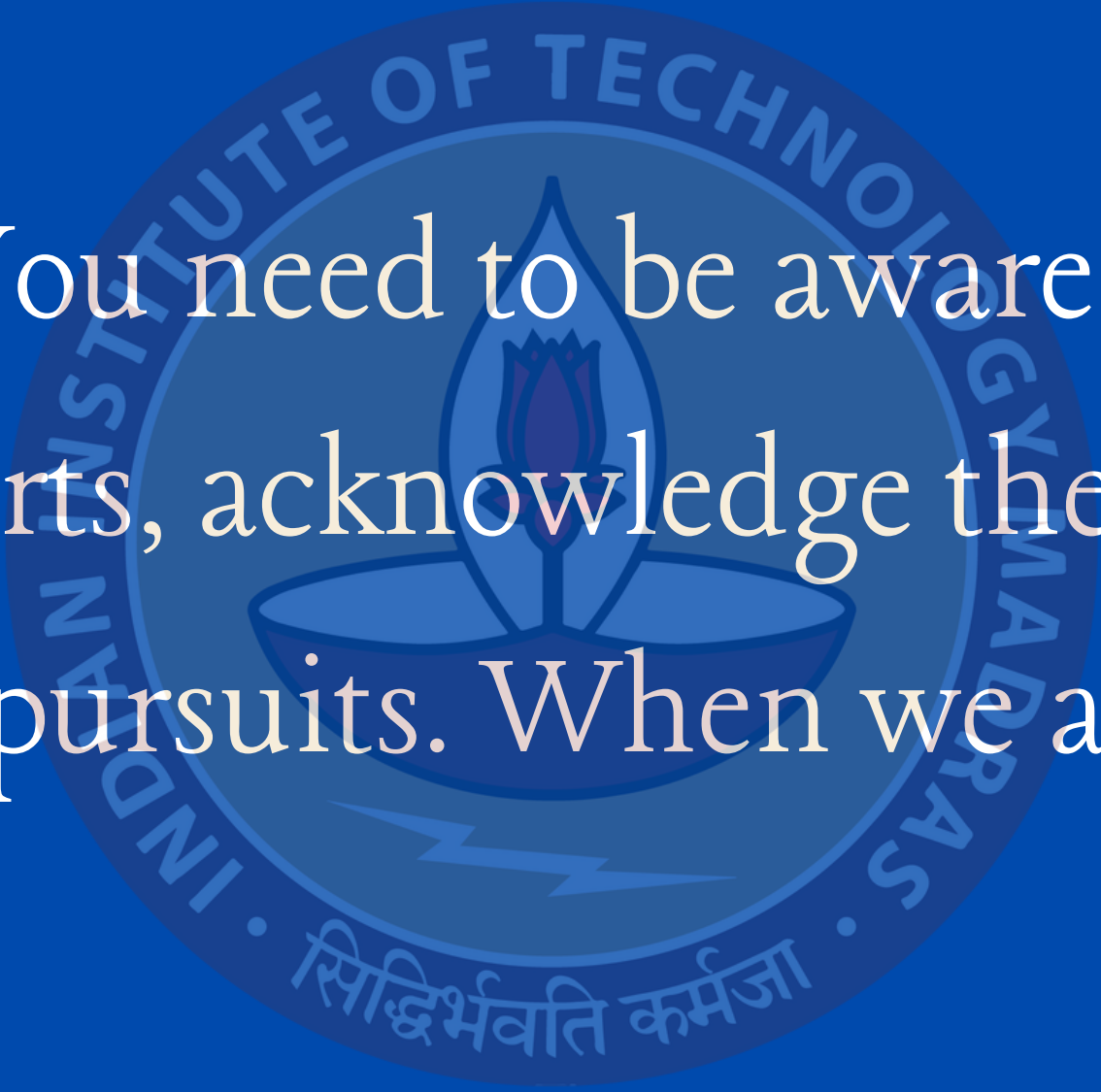
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What are some of the challenges associated with working in a team?
Explain with reference to a real life example.

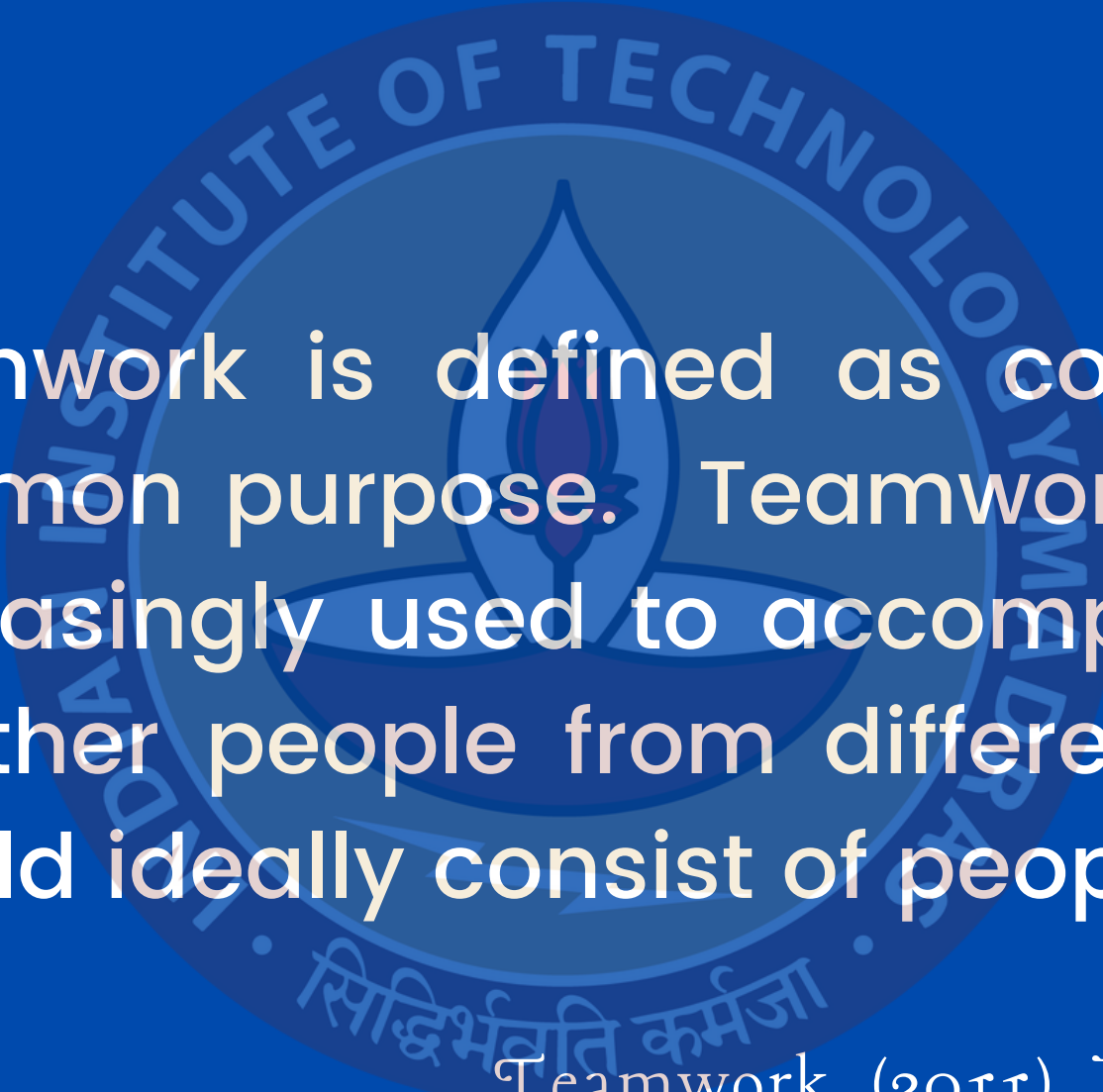


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The logo of the Indian Institute of Technology Madras is a circular emblem. It features a central lamp (diya) with a flame, set against a background of a lotus flower. The text "INDIAN INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY MADRAS" is written in a circular path around the central image. Below the lamp, there is a Sanskrit motto: "सिद्धिर्भवति कर्मजा".

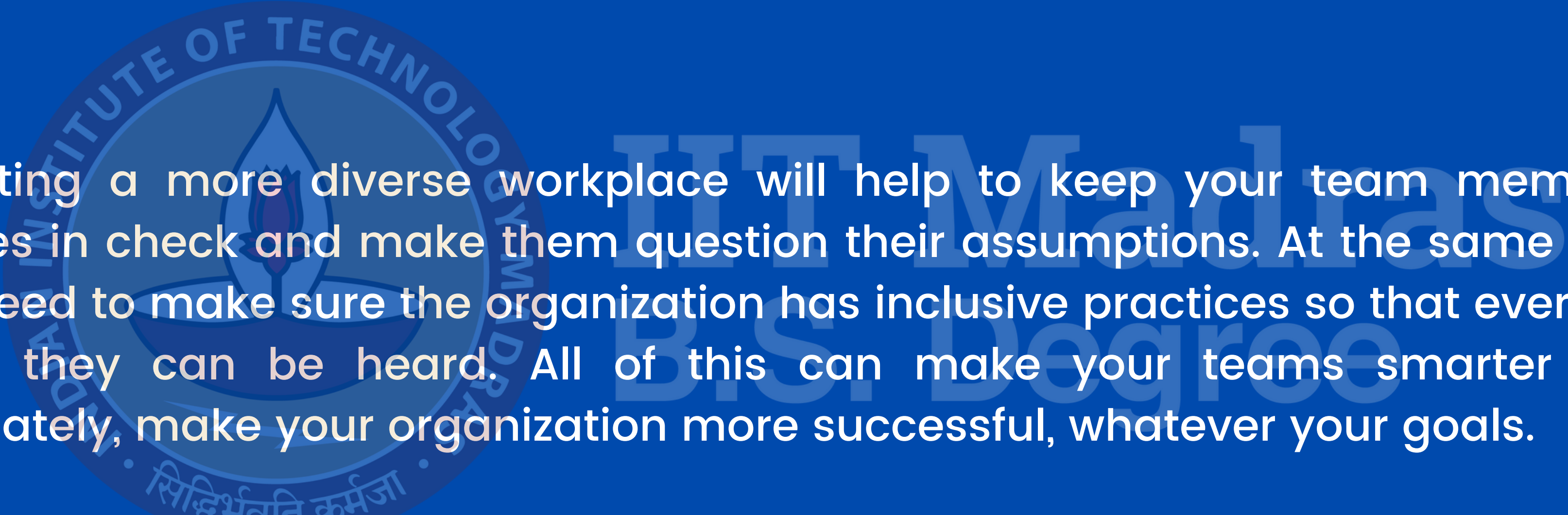
"You need to be aware of what others are doing, applaud their efforts, acknowledge their successes and encourage them in their pursuits. When we all help one another, everybody wins."

-- Jim Stovall

The logo of the Indian Institute of Technology Madras is visible in the background. It is a circular emblem with a blue border containing the text 'INDIAN INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY' at the top and 'MADRAS' at the bottom. Inside the circle is a stylized lamp with a flame, and below it is a banner with the Sanskrit motto 'सिद्धिर्भवति कर्मजा' (Siddhirbhavati Karmaja).

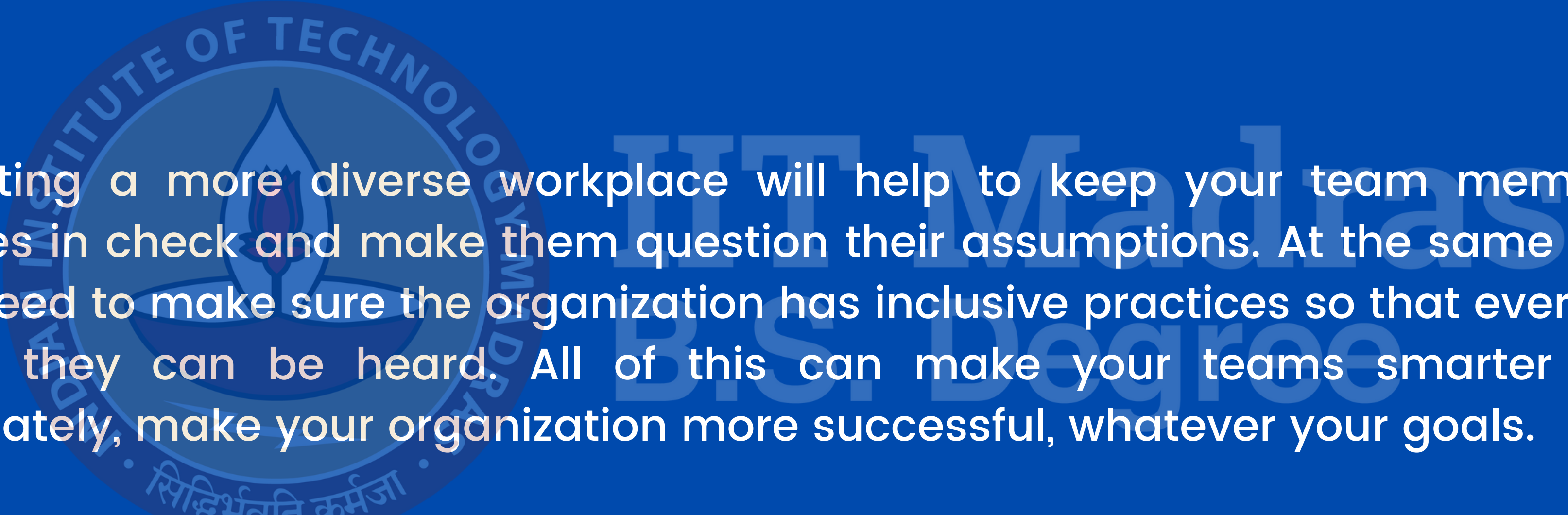
Teamwork is defined as collaboration by a group of people to achieve a common purpose. Teamwork is often a feature of day-to-day working, and is increasingly used to accomplish specific projects, in which case it may bring together people from different functions, departments, or disciplines. A team should ideally consist of people with complementary skills.

Teamwork. (2011). In Business: The Ultimate Resource. A&C Black.

The background features a large, semi-transparent watermark of the IIT Madras logo. The logo is circular, with the text 'INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY MADRAS' around the top and 'B.S. Degree' in the center. Inside the circle is a stylized lamp with a flame. Below the lamp is the Sanskrit motto 'सिद्धिर्भवति कर्मजा'.

Creating a more diverse workplace will help to keep your team members' biases in check and make them question their assumptions. At the same time, we need to make sure the organization has inclusive practices so that everyone feels they can be heard. All of this can make your teams smarter and, ultimately, make your organization more successful, whatever your goals.

Rock and Grant (2016). Why Diverse Teams Are Smarter. Harvard Business Review.

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